



The Selectboard
TOWN OF WESTHAMPTON
TOWN HALL
1 SOUTH ROAD
WESTHAMPTON, MASSACHUSETTS 01027

MINUTES of the MEETING
Monday, July 15, 2024, at 7:00 PM

The Westhampton Selectboard scheduled a regular meeting on Monday, July 15, 2024, at 7:00 PM at the Town Offices, 1 South Road.

Call to Order

The meeting was called to order at 7:00 PM by Mr. Scott Johndrow.

Present: Scott Johndrow, Susan Bronstein, Jennifer Milikowsky

Others Present: Douglas Finn; others as noted.

PUBLIC COMMENT – Michael and Linda Stacey (re/ P27 Event)

Michael and Linda Stacey (367 Main Road) addressed the board regarding their concerns about the recent P27 off-road motorcycle event that took place at or about 362 Main Road on or about June 29-30, 2024.

Mr. Stacey expressed displeasure that the event was permitted to take place at that location, stating that the venture appeared to be a business venture, permitted to take place in a location that was not zoned for business. In addition, Mr. Stacey expressed concerns about work done on the site, speed of traffic in the area concurrent with the site, and ongoing work on the site that appears to be expanding the cleared area and/or the entrance area.

There was some discussion relative to the process by which the previous event was considered. Ms. Milikowsky reiterated that there was no requirement for approval by the Selectboard, at the time.

Mr. Willaim Bell (371 Main Street) also noted excessive speed on the road at the time, and the increased activity on the site at the time.

Mr. Finn noted that the Selectboard is continuing to look at potential language relative to how large events are governed.

There was discussion relative to how other large events are looked at by the town.

Mr. Aaron Bauer, property owner, spoke about his efforts to preserve the safety of participants and the public, and to keep the event as organized and as low-key as possible.

There was some discussion relative to the noise level of the event on Sunday.

There was discussion relative to the potential recurrence of this type of activity at this site, and the regular road noise levels in the area.

The potential requirement for a permit for signs for the event was also noted.

No action taken.

INTERVIEW – Highway Clerk Finalist(s)

The board conducted a brief interview with Kayla Diggins, candidate for Westhampton Highway Department Town Clerk.

Mr. Finn noted that Ms. Diggins was the only applicant, but that her skillset appears to

meet the needs of the position, and she would bring a positive attitude to the job. Mr. Finn also noted that her references provided positive comments in Ms. Diggins' behalf.

After brief deliberation, it was MOVED by Bronstein, SECONDED by Milikowsky

To appoint Ms. Kayla Diggins as Highway Department Clerk.

VOTED: 3, 0, 0 (7:20 PM)

Department Report – Highway

Mr. Jablonski noted recent work that had been completed, including repairs to and expansion of a concrete pad at the Elementary School Well site, repairs of culverts and dirt roads, unplugging of clogged drainage pipes; mowing at the cemetery was completed.

Mr. Steve Holt noted that he had offered advice and support to the cemetery commission and the highway department, particularly in how to create an environment that will discourage beetle propagation.

Presentation / Discussion – “Complete Streets”

The board received a presentation by Joan Griswold (Hilltown CDC) and David Watson (Watson Active)

Mr. David Watson noted that he had been working with Ms. Griswold on trying to encourage small towns in Western Massachusetts to take advantage of the Complete Streets funding program.

Mr. Watson reviewed the history of the Complete Streets funding program, the steps necessary to qualify for such funding, and the types of projects for which the funds may be used.

Ms. Katch Bachelor noted that she was ‘spearheading’ the process relative to complete streets, and asked for Mr. Watson’s contact information.

Mr. Watson reiterated the value in the town pursuing a complete streets policy, and a prioritization plan, even if no projects are pursued or implemented.

Mr. Watson noted that a first-draft “Complete Streets” policy that had been circulated would likely meet the requirements of the program, but that he would be willing to offer advice and feedback to fine-tune the document.

There was extensive discussion relative to the cost of engineering of public works projects, and the limited financial resources available to the town.

Mr. Watson encouraged the town to adopt a policy, and pursue a prioritization plan, suggesting that engineering funding might become available for potential projects.

There was discussion about what types of projects that the town might pursue.

Mr. Watson suggested speed alerts might be a potential project that could be funded with complete streets funding.

There was extensive discussion about potential projects, and the benefits or detriments of those projects in Westhampton.

Mr. Watson suggested some avenues for education about the project, and possible options as the town moved forward with developing a policy.

Department Report – Board of Health

Ms. Katch Bachelor noted that a new office assistant had been hired at the Foothills Health

District, and would be in the office Monday through Thursday, 8 AM to 4:30 PM.

CLFRF / ARPA - Appropriation

Two proposals were considered by the Selectboard:

- \$2,000 for refurbishment of electrical service and addition of a Generator Sub Panel at the Westhampton Elementary School Well
- \$3,900 for hosting services for “SoftRight” accounting software

After discussion, it was MOVED by Milikowsky, SECONDED by Bronstein

To appropriate \$2,000 for the refurbishment of electrical service and addition of a Generator sub panel at the Westhampton Elementary School Well.

VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (8:33 PM)

Further, it was MOVED by Bronstein, SECONDED by Milikowsky

To appropriate \$3,900 for the refurbishment of electrical service and addition of a Generator sub panel at the Westhampton Elementary School Well.

VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (8:37 PM)

TOWN COORDINATOR UPDATE

Solar PV Array projects

Mr. Finn provided an update on the status of the project, noting that a draft RFP for both arrays would be ready for review no later than July 26. The board advised Mr. Finn to distribute the draft document to the MPIC ‘solar’ subcommittee for review and comment. Mr. Finn also noted that he planned to submit the draft RFP to town’s counsel for review – the board concurred.

Digital Equity Survey and Plan

Mr. Finn provided a brief update on the status of the Digital Equity Survey and Plan, which should be complete within a few weeks.

Cable Franchise Agreement - Public Hearing – August 12, 2024, 7 PM

Mr. Finn noted that a required public hearing, as required for the franchise renewal process, is scheduled for August 12, 2024.

Review of Correspondence

The board reviewed a letter from John Shaw, requesting appointment to the Police Study Committee.

It was MOVED by Milikowsky, SECONDED by Bronstein

To appoint John Shaw to the Police Study Committee.

VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (8:51 PM)

The board reviewed a request from Mr. Wally Marek to appoint Mr. Ronald Lauren as “Special Assistant Building Inspector”, in order to act as building inspector if any conflict exists. It was MOVED by Milikowsky, SECONDED by Bronstein

To appoint Mr. Ronald Laurin as "Special Assistant Building Inspector".

VOTED: 3, 0, 0 (8:53 PM)

Review/ Approval of AP and Payroll Warrants

After review, it was MOVED by Bronstein, SECONDED by Milikowsky

To approve AP Warrant W24-28 and Payroll warrant WP25-01 as presented.

VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (9:02 PM)

Review of Minutes

After review, it was MOVED by Bronstein, SECONDED by Milikowsky

To approve the minutes of July 1, 2024 as presented.

VOTED: 3, 0, 0 (9:04 PM)

New Business / Unanticipated Items *

Ms. Mary Lou Burgess expressed concern about gravel trucks with ripped coverings travelling along public ways, and signage at Outlook Farm that regularly blocks sightlines for drivers. The board took the matter under advisement.

Adjournment

There being no further business, it was MOVED by Bronstein, SECONDED by Johndrow

To adjourn.

VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (9:23 PM)

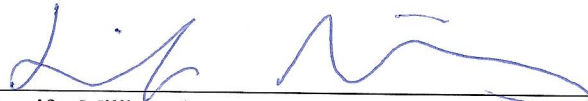
Respectfully submitted,

Douglas C. Finn

Approved by a vote of the Selectboard at a regular meeting, held on July 29, 2024.

Scott Johndrow


Susan Bronstein


Jennifer Milikowsky